Algebra I: Class Notes

Wilson Pan

February 27, 2026

Contents

1 Lecture 1: Group Actions & The Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem (Jan 12) 3
1.1 Permutations and Automorphisms . . . 3
1.2 Group Actions . . . 3
1.3 Orbits and Stabilizers . . . 4

2 Lecture 2: Cauchy's Theorem & Conjugation (Jan 14) 5
2.1 Cauchy's Theorem . . . 5
2.2 Conjugation . . . 5

3 Lecture 3: Sylow Preliminaries & Isomorphism Theorems (Jan 16) 7
3.1 Product of Subgroups . . . 7
3.2 Sylow Definitions . . . 7

4 Lecture 4: The Sylow Theorems (Jan 21) 8

5 Lecture 5: Normal Series & Solvability (Jan 23) 11
5.1 Normal and Subnormal Series . . . 11
5.2 Solvable Groups . . . 11

6 Lecture 6: Solvable and Derived Series (Jan 26) 12

7 Lecture 7: Nilpotent Groups and Free Groups (Jan 28) 14
7.1 Nilpotent Groups . . . 14
7.2 Free Groups . . . 15

8 Lecture 8: Free Groups 16

9 Lecture 9: Generators and Relations (Feb 2) 18

10 Lecture 10: Presentation of Groups (Feb 4) 20

11 Lecture 11: Category Theory (Feb 6) 21
11.1 Categories . . . 21

12 Lecture 12: Ring Theory (Feb 8) 23

13 Lecture 13: Ideals and Quotient Rings (Feb 10) 25

14 Lecture 14: Zorn's Lemma and Modules (Feb 13) 27
14.1 Modules 27

15 Lecture 15: Modules (Feb 16) 28

16 Lecture 16: Integral Domains 30

17 Lecture 17: PID (Feb 19) 32

18 Lecture 18: Unique Factorization Domains (Feb 23) 34

19 Lecture 19: (Feb 25) 36

1 Lecture 1: Group Actions & The Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem (Jan 12)

1.1 Permutations and Automorphisms

Definition 1.1 (Symmetric Group)**.** *Let X be a set. The set of all permutations (bijections) of X is denoted by Sym_X (or sometimes Σ_X). Under function composition, Sym_X forms a group.*

Definition 1.2 (Automorphism Group)**.** *Let $(G, \cdot)$ be a group. An automorphism of G is a bijection $\phi : G \to G$ that is also a homomorphism, i.e.,*

$$\phi(g_1 g_2) = \phi(g_1)\phi(g_2) \quad \forall g_1, g_2 \in G.$$

The set of all such automorphisms is denoted by $\mathrm{Aut}(G)$. It forms a group under composition.

1.2 Group Actions

Definition 1.3 (Group Action)**.** *Let G be a group and X be a set. An **action** of G on X is a homomorphism $\phi : G \to \mathrm{Sym}_X$.*
We typically write the action as $g \cdot x := \phi(g)(x)$. This notation satisfies two axioms (equivalent to the homomorphism property):

1. ***Identity:*** *$1 \cdot x = x$ for all $x \in X$.*
2. ***Compatibility:*** *$g_1 \cdot (g_2 \cdot x) = (g_1 g_2) \cdot x$ for all $g_1, g_2 \in G, x \in X$.*

Theorem 1.4 (Equivalence Relation on X)**.** *Let G act on X. Define a relation $\sim$ on X by:*

$$x_1 \sim x_2 \iff \exists g \in G \text{ such that } g \cdot x_1 = x_2.$$

Then $\sim$ is an equivalence relation.

Proof. We check the properties:

1. **Reflexive:** $1 \cdot x = x \implies x \sim x$.
2. **Symmetric:** If $g \cdot x_1 = x_2$, acting by g^{-1} gives $g^{-1} \cdot (g \cdot x_1) = g^{-1} \cdot x_2 \implies (g^{-1}g) \cdot x_1 = g^{-1} \cdot x_2 \implies x_1 = g^{-1} \cdot x_2$. Thus $x_2 \sim x_1$.
3. **Transitive:** If $g \cdot x_1 = x_2$ and $h \cdot x_2 = x_3$, then $h \cdot (g \cdot x_1) = x_3 \implies (hg) \cdot x_1 = x_3$. Thus $x_1 \sim x_3$.

$\square$

1.3 Orbits and Stabilizers

The equivalence classes under the relation $\sim$ partition the set X. These classes are called **orbits**.

Definition 1.5 (Orbit)**.** *For $x \in X$, the orbit of x is the set of all places x can be moved to by G:*

$$\mathcal{O}_x = Orb(x) = \{g \cdot x : g \in G\}.$$

Definition 1.6 (Stabilizer)**.** *For $x \in X$, the stabilizer of x is the set of elements in G that fix x:*

$$G_x = \mathrm{Stab}(x) = \{g \in G : g \cdot x = x\}.$$

Note that G_x is a subgroup of G (denoted $G_x \leq G$).

Theorem 1.7 (**Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem**)**.** *Let G act on X. For any $x \in X$, there is a bijection between the orbit $\mathcal{O}_x$ and the set of left cosets G/G_x. Consequently:*

$$|\mathcal{O}_x| = [G : G_x].$$

If G is finite, $|G| = |\mathcal{O}_x| \cdot |G_x|$.

Proof. Define a map $\psi : G/G_x \to \mathcal{O}_x$ by $\psi(gG_x) = g \cdot x$.

1. **Well-defined:** Suppose $g_1G_x = g_2G_x$. Then $g_1^{-1}g_2 \in G_x$, so $(g_1^{-1}g_2) \cdot x = x$, implying $g_2 \cdot x = g_1 \cdot x$.

2. **Injectivity:** If $\psi(g_1G_x) = \psi(g_2G_x)$, then $g_1 \cdot x = g_2 \cdot x$. Multiplying by g_1^{-1}, we get $x = g_1^{-1}g_2 \cdot x$, so $g_1^{-1}g_2 \in G_x$, implying $g_1G_x = g_2G_x$.

3. **Surjectivity:** By definition, any $y \in \mathcal{O}_x$ is of the form $g \cdot x$ for some g, which is exactly $\psi(gG_x)$.

Thus, ψ is a bijection. $\square$

2 Lecture 2: Cauchy's Theorem & Conjugation (Jan 14)

2.1 Cauchy's Theorem

Lemma 2.1. *If X is a finite set and G is a p-group (a group of order p^k) acting on X, then:*

$$|X| \equiv |X^G| \pmod{p},$$

where $X^G = \{x \in X : g \cdot x = x, \forall g \in G\}$ is the set of fixed points.

Theorem 2.2 (Cauchy's Theorem)**.** *If G is a finite group and p is a prime dividing $|G|$, then G has an element of order p.*

Proof (McKay's Proof). Let X be the set of p-tuples of elements of G whose product is the identity:

$$X = \{(g_1, \ldots, g_p) \in G^p : g_1 g_2 \cdots g_p = 1\}.$$

Notice that g_p is uniquely determined by the first $p-1$ elements ($g_p = (g_1 \cdots g_{p-1})^{-1}$), so $|X| = |G|^{p-1}$. Since $p \mid |G|$, we have $p \mid |X|$.
Let $\mathbb{Z}_p$ (cyclic group of order p) act on X by cyclic shift:

$$\sigma \cdot (g_1, g_2, \ldots, g_p) = (g_2, g_3, \ldots, g_p, g_1).$$

This is a valid action because if $g_1 \cdots g_p = 1$, then $g_1(g_2 \cdots g_p) = 1 \implies g_2 \cdots g_p = g_1^{-1}$, so $(g_2 \cdots g_p)g_1 = g_1^{-1} g_1 = 1$.
By the Lemma, $|X| \equiv |X^{\mathbb{Z}_p}| \pmod{p}$. Fixed points are tuples $(a, a, \ldots, a)$ such that $a^p = 1$. Since $(1, \ldots, 1) \in X^{\mathbb{Z}_p}$, the set of fixed points is non-empty. Since p divides $|X|$ and p divides the congruence $|X| - |X^{\mathbb{Z}_p}|$, p must divide $|X^{\mathbb{Z}_p}|$. Therefore, there are at least p fixed points. There must exist some $a \neq 1$ such that $a^p = 1$. □

2.2 Conjugation

Conjugation is a specific action of G on itself.

Definition 2.3. *For $g, h \in G$, the **conjugate** of g by h is $g^h := hgh^{-1}$. The map $\phi_h : G \to G$ defined by $g \mapsto hgh^{-1}$ is an automorphism (an inner automorphism).*

Definition 2.4 (Classes and Centralizers)**.** *Let G act on itself by conjugation ($h \cdot g = hgh^{-1}$).*

- *The orbit of g is the **Conjugacy Class** of g: $Cl(g) = \{hgh^{-1} : h \in G\}$.*
- *The stabilizer of g is the **Centralizer** of g: $C_G(g) = \{h \in G : hg = gh\}$.*

By Orbit-Stabilizer: $|Cl(g)| = [G : C_G(g)]$.

Definition 2.5 (Center of G)**.** *The* ***Center****, $Z(G)$, is the set of elements that commute with everything:*

$$Z(G) = \{z \in G : zg = gz, \forall g \in G\} = \bigcap_{g \in G} C_G(g).$$

$Z(G)$ is the kernel of the conjugation homomorphism $G \to \mathrm{Aut}(G)$. Thus $Z(G) \trianglelefteq G$.

Definition 2.6 (Normalizer)**.** *Let $H \leq G$. The* ***Normalizer*** *of H in G is:*

$$N_G(H) = \{g \in G : gHg^{-1} = H\}.$$

$N_G(H)$ is the largest subgroup of G in which H is normal.

3 Lecture 3: Sylow Preliminaries & Isomorphism Theorems (Jan 16)

3.1 Product of Subgroups

Definition 3.1. *Let $K, N \leq G$. Define $KN = \{kn : k \in K, n \in N\}$.*

- *In general, KN is not a subgroup.*
- *If $N \trianglelefteq G$ (or just $N \subseteq N_G(K)$), then KN is a subgroup.*
- *Size formula: $|KN| = \frac{|K||N|}{|K \cap N|}$.*

Theorem 3.2 (Second Isomorphism Theorem)**.** *Let $K \leq G$ and $N \trianglelefteq G$. Then $K \cap N \trianglelefteq K$, and*

$$\frac{KN}{N} \cong \frac{K}{K \cap N}.$$

Proof. Consider the natural projection $\pi : G \to G/N$. Restrict it to K, i.e., $\phi = \pi\mathrm{res}_K : K \to G/N$. The image of ϕ is $\{kN : k \in K\} = KN/N$. The kernel of ϕ is $\{k \in K : kN = N\} = \{k \in K : k \in N\} = K \cap N$. By the First Isomorphism Theorem, $K/\ker(\phi) \cong \mathrm{Im}(\phi)$. □

3.2 Sylow Definitions

Definition 3.3 (p-group)**.** *Let p be a prime. A group G is a p-group if every element has order a power of p. For finite groups, this is equivalent to $|G| = p^k$.*

Definition 3.4 (Sylow p-subgroup)**.** *Let $|G| = p^n m$ where $p \nmid m$. A subgroup $P \leq G$ is called a **Sylow p-subgroup** if $|P| = p^n$.*

$$Syl_p(G) = \{P \leq G : P \text{ is a Sylow } p\text{-subgroup}\}.$$

4 Lecture 4: The Sylow Theorems (Jan 21)

Theorem 4.1 (**The Sylow Theorems**). *Let G be a finite group of order $p^n m$ where $p \nmid m$.*

1. ***Existence:*** *$Syl_p(G) \neq \emptyset$. (There exists a subgroup of order p^n).*
2. ***Conjugacy:*** *Any two Sylow p-subgroups are conjugate in G. That is, if $P, Q \in Syl_p(G)$, $\exists g \in G$ such that $gPg^{-1} = Q$.*
3. ***Number:*** *Let $n_p = |Syl_p(G)|$. Then:*
   - $n_p \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$.
   - $n_p \mid m$ *(equivalently $n_p \mid |G|$).*

Proof. Let p be a prime such that $p \,\Big|\, |G|$. Define the set of all p-subgroups:

$$\Sigma = \{H : H \leq G, |H| = p^n \text{ for some } n > 0\}.$$

Define Ω as the set of maximal elements in Σ under inclusion:

$$\Omega = \{H : H \in \Sigma, \text{ there is no } K \in \Sigma \text{ such that } H \subsetneq K\}.$$

We let G act on the set of subgroups $\{H : H \leq G\}$ by conjugation. Since conjugation is an isomorphism ($H^g \simeq H$), it preserves the order of subgroups. Thus:

$$H \in \Sigma \iff H^g \in \Sigma \quad \text{and} \quad H \in \Omega \iff H^g \in \Omega.$$

Therefore, G acts on Ω by $g \cdot H = H^g$.

Claim 1: Let $H \in \Omega$. Consider the action of H on Ω by conjugation. Then H is the *unique* fixed point of this action.

Proof of Claim:

- **Existence:** It is trivial to see that H is a fixed point, as $H^h = hHh^{-1} = H$ for any $h \in H$.
- **Uniqueness:** Let $K \in \Omega$ be a fixed point of the action of H.

  $$K \text{ is fixed by } H \iff K^h = K \quad \forall h \in H \iff H \leq N_G(K).$$

  Since $K \trianglelefteq N_G(K)$, and $H \leq N_G(K)$, the product HK is a subgroup of $N_G(K)$, and thus $HK \leq G$. Using our counting lemma:

  $$|HK| = \frac{|H||K|}{|H \cap K|}.$$

  Since $H, K \in \Omega$, their orders are powers of p. Thus $|HK|$ is a power of p, meaning $HK \in \Sigma$.

  We have $H \leq HK$. Since H is maximal in Σ (by definition of Ω) and $HK \in \Sigma$, it must be that $H = HK$. Similarly, $K \leq HK$ implies $K = HK$. Therefore, $H = K$.

Claim 2: Size of Ω Modulo p

Statement: $|\Omega| \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$.

Proof of Claim: Let $H \in \Omega$. We decompose Ω into disjoint orbits under the action of H.

$$\Omega = \{H\} \cup \bigcup_{K \neq H} \mathrm{Orb}_H(K).$$

By Claim 1, H is the only fixed point (an orbit of size 1). For any $K \in \Omega$ with $K \neq H$, the stabilizer of K in H is a proper subgroup, so by the Orbit-Stabilizer theorem for p-groups, $|\mathrm{Orb}_H(K)|$ is divisible by p.

$$|\Omega| = 1 + \sum(\text{multiples of } p) \implies |\Omega| \equiv 1 \pmod{p}.$$

Claim 3: Transitivity (Conjugacy of Elements in Ω)

Statement: Any two elements of Ω are conjugate.

Proof of Claim: Suppose for contradiction that $H, K \in \Omega$ are not conjugates. Let $\theta_1 = \mathrm{Orb}_G(H)$ and $\theta_2 = \mathrm{Orb}_G(K)$. Since they are distinct orbits, $\theta_1 \cap \theta_2 = \emptyset$.

Consider the action of H on these sets:

- On θ_1: $H \in \theta_1$. By Claim 1, H is the unique fixed point of H in Ω. Since $\theta_1 \subseteq \Omega$, H is the unique fixed point in θ_1. Thus, $|\theta_1| \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$.
- On θ_2: Since $H \in \theta_1$ and $\theta_1 \cap \theta_2 = \emptyset$, we have $H \notin \theta_2$. Therefore, θ_2 contains *no* fixed points under the action of H (because the only fixed point in all of Ω is H). Thus, every orbit of H inside θ_2 has size divisible by p. This implies $|\theta_2| \equiv 0 \pmod{p}$.

By symmetry, we can swap the roles of H and K. Running the same argument with K acting on the sets implies $|\theta_2| \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$ and $|\theta_1| \equiv 0 \pmod{p}$.

This results in a contradiction (e.g., $|\theta_1| \equiv 1$ and $|\theta_1| \equiv 0$). Thus, $\theta_1 = \theta_2$, so H and K are conjugate.

Corollary: Since there is only one orbit, $\Omega = \theta_1$. Thus $|\Omega| = |\theta_1| \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$.

Claim 4: Divisibility

Statement: $|\Omega| \,\Big|\, |G|$.

Proof of Claim: Let $H \in \Omega$. Since Ω is exactly the orbit of H under conjugation (from Claim 3), the size of the orbit is the index of the stabilizer:

$$|\Omega| = [G : \mathrm{Stab}_G(H)] = [G : N_G(H)] = \frac{|G|}{|N_G(H)|}.$$

Thus $|\Omega|$ divides $|G|$.

Claim 5: Identification with Sylow Subgroups

Statement: $\Omega = Syl_p(G)$.

Proof of Claim: We know $Syl_p(G) \subseteq \Omega$ because Sylow subgroups are maximal p-subgroups by definition. We must show the reverse: every $H \in \Omega$ is a Sylow p-subgroup.

Let $H \in \Omega$. Assume for contradiction that $H \notin Syl_p(G)$. Let $|G| = p^s m$ where $p \nmid m$. Since H is a p-group but not Sylow, $|H| = p^t$ with $t < s$.
Consider the normalizer $N_G(H)$. From Claim 2, we know $|\Omega| = [G : N_G(H)] \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$. Therefore, p does *not* divide $[G : N_G(H)]$. Since $|G| = [G : N_G(H)] \cdot |N_G(H)|$, all factors of p in $|G|$ must reside in $|N_G(H)|$. Thus, $|N_G(H)|$ is divisible by p^s.
Consequently, the index $[N_G(H) : H] = \frac{|N_G(H)|}{|H|} = \frac{(\text{multiple of } p^s)}{p^t}$ is divisible by p (since $s > t$).
By Cauchy's Theorem applied to the quotient group $N_G(H)/H$, there exists a subgroup of order p, say $\bar{K} \leq N_G(H)/H$. By the Correspondence Theorem, there exists a subgroup K such that $H \leq K \leq N_G(H)$ with $|K| = p \cdot |H| = p^{t+1}$.
Since K is a p-group, $K \in \Sigma$. However, $H \subsetneq K$, which contradicts the definition of H as a maximal element in Ω.
Therefore, H must already be of order p^s. Thus $\Omega = Syl_p(G)$. $\square$

5 Lecture 5: Normal Series & Solvability (Jan 23)

5.1 Normal and Subnormal Series

Definition 5.1. *A **subnormal series** of a group G is a chain of subgroups:*

$$\{1\} = H_0 \leq H_1 \leq \cdots \leq H_k = G$$

*such that $H_i \trianglelefteq H_{i+1}$ for all i. The quotient groups H_{i+1}/H_i are called the **factors** of the series.*

Definition 5.2 (Composition Series)**.** *A subnormal series is a **composition series** if all factors H_{i+1}/H_i are **simple** groups (non-trivial groups with no normal subgroups other than $\{1\}$ and themselves).*

Theorem 5.3 (Jordan-Hölder)**.** *Any two composition series of a finite group G are equivalent. That is, they have the same length, and their factors are isomorphic (up to reordering).*

5.2 Solvable Groups

Definition 5.4. *A group G is **solvable** if it has a subnormal series where all factors H_{i+1}/H_i are **abelian**.*

Definition 5.5 (Commutator)**.** *The commutator of g, h is $[g, h] = ghg^{-1}h^{-1}$. The **Derived Subgroup** (or Commutator Subgroup) G' or $[G, G]$ is the subgroup generated by all commutators.*

Proposition 5.6. *G/N is abelian if and only if $[G, G] \leq N$. Thus, $[G, G]$ is the smallest normal subgroup such that the quotient is abelian.*

Remark 5.7 (Derived Series)**.** *Define $G^{(0)} = G$, $G^{(1)} = [G, G]$, and $G^{(i+1)} = [G^{(i)}, G^{(i)}]$. G is solvable if and only if the derived series terminates at $\{1\}$ (i.e., $G^{(n)} = \{1\}$ for some n).*

6 Lecture 6: Solvable and Derived Series (Jan 26)

Lemma 6.1. *Let $\alpha \in Aut(G)$ then $\alpha([g,h]) = [\alpha(g), \alpha(h)]$.*

Lemma 6.2. *For $N \trianglelefteq G$ then G/N is abelian iff $[G,G] \leq N$.*

Theorem 6.3. *If $N \trianglelefteq G$, $g, h \in G$ and $[gN, hN] = [g,h]N$. Additionally, gN and hN commutes iff $[g,h]N = N$ iff $[g,h] \subseteq N$.*

Definition 6.4. *G is solvable iff there is a subnormal series $\langle H_i : 0 \leq i \leq t \rangle$ such that $[H_{i+1}, H_{i+1}] \leq H_i$ for all $0 \leq i \leq t-1$.*

Theorem 6.5. *The following are true*

1. *If G solvable and $K \leq G$ then K is solvable*
2. *If G is solvable and $N \trianglelefteq G$ then G/N is solvable.*
3. *For $N \trianglelefteq G$, G solvable iff both N and G/N are solvable*

Proof. We prove the previous theorems

1. Let $\langle H_i : 0 \leq i \leq t \rangle$ be a series in G such that $[H_{i+1}, H_{i+1}] \leq H_i$ for all $0 \leq i \leq t-1$. We can let $H_i' = K \cap H_i$ for $0 \leq i \leq t$ and we need to verify $\langle H_i' : 0 \leq i \leq t \rangle$ is a solvable series in K.
2. Let $\langle H_i : 0 \leq i \leq t \rangle$ be a series in G such that $[H_{i+1}, H_{i+1}] \leq H_i$ for all $0 \leq i \leq t-1$. Let $H_i' = \phi_N[H_i] = H_i N/N$. Verify it is solvable.
3. The forward direction is trivial by (1) and (2). For the reverse direction, N solvable and G/N solvable $\langle N_i : 0 \leq i \leq s \rangle$ subnormal in N and N_{i+1}/N_i abelian and similar for $\langle H_j N/N : 0 \leq j \leq t \rangle$ subnormal in G/N and $(H_{j+1}N/N)_{j+1}/(H_j N/N)$ abelian. We know $H_{j+1} \trianglelefteq H_j$ and $[H_{j+1}, H_{j+1}] \leq H_j$ for all $0 \leq j \leq t-1$. So $N_0 = 1 \trianglelefteq N_1 \cdots \trianglelefteq N_s = N = H_0 \trianglelefteq H_1 \cdots \trianglelefteq H_t = G$.

□

Definition 6.6. *Given G, the derived series of G is given by $G_0' = G$ and $G_{i+1}' = [G_i', G_i']$ for $i \geq 0$.*

Theorem 6.7. *G is solvable iff there is n such that $G_n' = \{1\}$.*

Proof. For the backwards direction, by construction G_i'/G_{i+1}' is abelian. Let $H_j = G_{n-j}$. For the forward direction, let $\langle H_j : 0 \leq j \leq n \rangle$ be a subnormal series in G, H_{j+1}/H_j abelian. Show by induction that $G_i' \leq H_{n-i}$ for all i. □

Theorem 6.8. *Suppose G abelian and simple, let $a \in G$ and $a \neq 1$ then $G = \langle a \rangle$ and $|a|$ is prime.*

Theorem 6.9. *Let G be simple and let $\langle H_i : 0 \leq i \leq t \rangle$ be subnormal series in G. Then there is $n < t$ such that $H_i = 1$ for $0 \leq i \leq n$ and $H_i = G$ for $n < i \leq t$.*

7 Lecture 7: Nilpotent Groups and Free Groups (Jan 28)

7.1 Nilpotent Groups

Definition 7.1. *For $H, K \leq G$, $[H, K] = \langle [h, k] : h \in H, k \in K \rangle$*

Remark 7.2. *G_i' is characteristic in G for all i, in particular $G_i' \trianglelefteq G$.*

Lemma 7.3. *If $N \trianglelefteq G, N \leq H \leq G$ then*

$$\frac{H}{N} \leq Z\left(\frac{G}{N}\right) \iff [G, H] \leq N.$$

Definition 7.4. *A normal series in G, $\langle H_i : 0 \leq i \leq t \rangle$ is a central series if $\frac{H_{i+1}}{H_i} \leq Z\left(\frac{G}{H_i}\right)$ for all $0 \leq i \leq t-1$. Equivalently, $[G, H_{i+1}] \leq H_i$ for all $0 \leq i \leq t-1$.*

Definition 7.5. *G is nilpotent iff G has a central series.*

Remark 7.6. *Nilpotent groups are solvable.*

Definition 7.7. *Let G be a group*

1. *The descending central series is the sequence of subgroup given by $\gamma_1(G) = G$ and $\gamma_{i+1}(G) = [G, \gamma_i(G)]$ for $i \geq 1$.*
2. *The ascending central series is the sequence of subgroup given by $Z_0(G) = 1$ and*

$$\frac{Z_{n+1}(G)}{Z_n(G)} = Z\left(\frac{G}{Z_n(G)}\right).$$

Remark 7.8. *By induction, $Z_n(G)$ and $\gamma_n(G)$ are characteristic in G. and $Z_n(G) \trianglelefteq G$ and $\gamma_n(G) \trianglelefteq G$ for all $n \geq 0$.*

Remark 7.9. *For any G and $N \trianglelefteq G, [G, N] \leq N$ because for any $g \in G, n \in N$ we have $[g, n] = gng^{-1}n^{-1}$ and $n^g \in N$ since $N \trianglelefteq G$. So $[G, N] \leq N$.*

Theorem 7.10. *G is nilpotent iff there is a $n \geq 0$ such that $Z_n(G) = G$ iff there is $n \geq 0$ such that $\gamma_{n+1}(G) = \{1\}$. Moreover, the least n such that $Z_n(G) = G$ is the least n such that $\gamma_{n+1}(G) = \{1\}$.*

Proof. Take any central series then the decreasing and ascending central series will grow at least as fast as the arbitrary central series. □

7.2 Free Groups

Example 7.11. *Consider $\mathbb{Z} = (\mathbb{Z}, +)$, 1 is a generator $\mathbb{Z} = \langle 1 \rangle$. The universal property of $\mathbb{Z}$, 1. For any group G and any $g \in G$, there is a unique homomorphism $\phi : \mathbb{Z} \to G$ and $\phi(1) = g$.*

Proof. If ϕ exist let $\phi(n) = g^n$ then ϕ is a homomorphism. □

g is free because whatever 1 is mapped to in the homomorphism it won't mess you up compared to a finite group.

Definition 7.12. *F is a free group on 2 element if*

1. *There exist $a, b \in F$, $F = \langle a, b \rangle$*
2. *For all G, all $g, h \in G$ there is a unique homomorphism $\phi : F \to G$ such that $\phi(a) = g$ and $\phi(b) = h$.*

8 Lecture 8: Free Groups

Theorem 8.1. *For any set X, there are a group F and an injective function $i : X \to F$ such that*

1. *For any group G and any function $f : X \to G$ there is a unique homomorphism $\phi : F \to G$ such that $\phi(i(x)) = f(x)$ for all $x \in X$.*

$$\begin{tikzcd} X \arrow[r, hook, "i"] \arrow[dr, "f"'] & F \arrow[d, dashed, "\phi"] \\ & G \end{tikzcd}$$

   The diagram commutes: $\phi \circ i = f$. The homomorphism ϕ is unique.

2. *F is generated by $i[X]$*

Proof. A word (on alphabet X) is a (possibly empty) finite sequence from $X \times \mathbb{Z}$. We will write $x_1^{n_1} x_2^{n_2} \cdots x_k^{n_k}$ for the word $x_1, x_2, \ldots, x_k$ for $\langle (x_1, n_1), (x_2, n_2), \ldots, (x_k, n_k) \rangle$.

Example 8.2. *Let $X = \{x, y, z\}$ then $w = x^0 x^{15} y^{-23} z^{27}$ is a word.*

Let w be the set of words. Given a word, we can possibly perform a reduction step

1. If word contains an entry $\langle x, 0 \rangle$, remove it.
2. If the word contains successive entries $\langle x, n \rangle$ and $\langle x, m \rangle$ then replace them with $\langle x, n + m \rangle$.

Example 8.3. $y^{15} x^3 x^{-2} x^{-1} y^2 z^5 \to y^{15} x^1 x^{-1} y^2 z^5 \to y^{15} x^0 y^2 z^5 \to y^{15} y^2 z^5 \to y^{17} z^5$.

Let R be set of all reduced words, where no more reductions can be done.
For any word w, there is a unique reduced word w' such that w can be transformed into w' by a finite set of reductions.
We will not be bale to show this property using group properties but instead we'll produce a group F with the property that every word is equivalent to a unique reduced word.

Given $x \in X$, I will replace $f_x : F \to F$

1. w does not begin with some x^m then $f_x(w) = xw$
2. w is of the form $x^{-1} v$ then $f_x(w) = v$
3. w is of the form $x^n v$ for $n \neq -1$ then $f_x(w) = x^{n+1} v$

I also define $g_x : R \to R$ by

1. w does not begin with some x^n then $g_x(w) = x^{-1} w$
2. w is of the form $x^1 v$ then $g_x(w) = v$
3. w is of the form $x^n v$ for $n \neq 1$ then $g_x(w) = x^{n-1} v$

We can observe that $f_x \circ g_x = g_x \circ f_x = 1_R$.
For each $x \in X$, $f_x \in \sum_R$ (the group of permutations of R) and $g_x = f_x^{-1}$. Let F be the subgroup of $\sum_R$ generated by $\{f_x : x \in X\}$ or $\{f_{x_1}^{n_1}, ..., f_{x_t}^{n_t} : x_i \in X, n_i \in \mathbb{Z}\}$.
Let $i : X \to F$ with $i(x) = f_x$. For any word $w = x_1^{n_1} x_2^{n_2} \cdots x_t^{n_t}$. Let $f_w = f_{x_1}^{n_1} f_{x_2}^{n_2} \cdots f_{x_t}^{n_t} \in F$.
Key Facts:

1. If w is obtained from $\overline{w}$ by a single reduction step, $f_w = f_{\overline{w}}$.
2. If w is obtained from $\overline{w}$ by any sequence of reduction steps, then $f_w = f_{\overline{w}}$.
3. If $w \in R$ then $f_w(\langle\rangle) = w$
4. For any word $w, f_w(\langle\rangle)$ the unique reduced word to which w can be transformed by reduction step.
5. If w_1, w_2 are reduced words then $v =$ unique reduction of $w_1 w_2$, $f_v = f_{w_1} f_{w_2}$

Let F' be the group whose underlying set is R whose operation is "concatenate and reduce". Then $F \simeq F'$ by $f_v \mapsto v$. To finish, let G be a group, $h : X \to G$ function. We want to find there is a unique homomorphism ϕ with $F' \to G$ and $\phi \circ i = h$.

1. If ϕ exists then

$$\begin{aligned}\phi(x_1^{n_1} x_2^{n_2} \cdots x_t^{n_t}) &= \phi(i(x_1))^{n_1} \phi(i(x_2))^{n_2} \cdots \phi(i(x_t))^{n_t} \\ &= h(x_1)^{n_1} h(x_2)^{n_2} \cdots h(x_t)^{n_t}\end{aligned}$$

2. Verify ϕ is a homomorphism.

□

Example 8.4. *Let $X = \langle x, y\rangle$, let G be any group with 2 generators say $G = \langle a, b\rangle$. Let F be a free group on X. Let $\phi : F \to G$ be unique homomorphism such that $\phi(x) = a$ and $\phi(y) = b$. ϕ is surjective because G is generated by a and b. Thus, $G \simeq \frac{F}{\ker \phi}$.*

9 Lecture 9: Generators and Relations (Feb 2)

Definition 9.1. *let X be a set, let F be a free group on X. Let $A \subseteq F$ and $N =$ least normal subgroup of F containing A.*

Theorem 9.2. *Let $\overline{F} = F/N$ and $j : X \to \overline{F}$ by $j(x) = xN$.*

$$\begin{tikzcd} F \arrow[r, "\phi_N"] & \overline{F} \\ X \arrow[u, "i"] \arrow[ur, "j"] & \end{tikzcd}$$

The following are true:

1. *$\overline{F}$ is generated by $\{j(x) : x \in X\}$. Let $\overline{x} = j(x)$*
2. *If $a = x_1^{n_1} x_2^{n_2} \cdots x_t^{n_t} \in A$ then $a \in N$ and $\overline{x_1}^{n_1} \overline{x_2}^{n_2} \cdots \overline{x_t}^{n_t} = \phi_N(a) = 1_{\overline{F}}$*

"Universal Property of $\overline{F}$": Let G be a group and let $h : X \to G$ such that $a = x_1^{n_1} x_2^{n_2} \cdots x_t^{n_t} \in A$ and $h(x_1)^{n_1} h(x_2)^{n_2} \cdots h(x_t)^{n_t} = 1_G$. There is an unique homomorphism $\mathcal{T} : \overline{F} \to G$ such that

$$\begin{tikzcd} X \arrow[r, "j"] \arrow[dr, "h"'] & \overline{F} \arrow[d, dashed, "\mathcal{T}"] \\ & G \end{tikzcd}$$

So $h = \mathcal{T} \circ j$

Proof. Since $\{\overline{x} : x \in X\}$ generates $\overline{F}$ there is at most one τ. By universal property of F, there is unique homomorphism $\phi : F \to G$ such that

$$\phi(x^1) = h(x). \qquad \text{(For all } x \in X\text{)}$$

Use property of F

$$\begin{tikzcd} X \arrow[r, "i"] \arrow[dr, "h"'] & F \arrow[d, dashed, "\phi"] \\ & G \end{tikzcd}$$

Claim: By hypothesis on h, $A \subseteq \ker(\phi)$.
Let $a = x_1^{t_1} x_2^{t_2} \cdots x_k^{t_k} \in A$ then $\phi(a) = \phi(x_1)^{t_1} \phi(x_2)^{t_2} \cdots \phi(x_k)^{t_k} = h(x_1)^{t_1} h(x_2)^{t_2} \cdots h(x_k)^{t_k} = 1_G$ since $h(x_1)^{t_1} h(x_2)^{t_2} \cdots h(x_k)^{t_k} = 1_G$. Thus, $a \in \ker(\phi)$.

By choice of N, $N \leq \ker(\phi)$, we'll attempt to define $\tau : \overline{F} \to G$ by $\tau(wN) = \phi(w)$ for $w \in F$.
τ is well defined because $w_1 N = w_2 N \implies w_1^{-1} w_2 \in N \implies w_1^{-1} w_2 \in \ker(\phi) \implies \phi(w_1)^{-1} \phi(w_2) = 1 \implies \phi(w_1) = \phi(w_2)$. Showing τ is a homomorphism is straightforward.

$$\begin{tikzcd}
X \arrow[r, "i"] \arrow[dr, "h"'] & F \arrow[d, "\phi_N"] \arrow[dr, "\phi"] & \\
& \overline{F} \arrow[r, dashed, "\mathcal{T}"] & G
\end{tikzcd}$$

$\square$

10 Lecture 10: Presentation of Groups (Feb 4)

Example 10.1. *Dihedral Group: D_n = symmetry group of a regular n-gon.*
Let $D_n = \langle a, b\rangle$ where a = rotation by $\frac{2\pi}{n}$ and b = reflection about the vertical axis. Then D_n is generated by a and b with the relations $a^n = 1$ and $b^2 = 1$.
We have $bab^{-1}a = 1$
Let $X = \{x, y\}$ and F be free group and $A = \{x^n, y^2, yxy^{-1}x\}$ and N = least normal subgroup $\supseteq A$. Let $\overline{x} = xN$ and $\overline{y} = yN$. Then $F/N = \langle \overline{x}, \overline{y}\rangle$ and

$$\overline{yxy^{-1}x} = \overline{yxy}^{-1}\overline{x}^{-1} = 1_{\overline{F}}.$$

There is a unique homomorphism $\tau : F/N \to D_n$ such that $\tau(\overline{x}) = a$ and $\tau(\overline{y}) = b$ as $D_n = \langle a, b\rangle$ so τ is surjective. So $|F/N| \geq 2n$.
Claim: $|F/N| \leq 2n$ (so τ is isomorphism)
Proof: Using relations from before, we can simply write any expression in $\overline{x}, \overline{y}$ down to $\overline{x}^s\overline{y}^t$ for $0 \leq s \leq n$ and $0 \leq t \leq 2$.

11 Lecture 11: Category Theory (Feb 6)

11.1 Categories

Example 11.1. *1. Category of sets, if we have two sets A and B then $A \to B$ is a function $f : A \to B$*

2. Category of groups, if we have two groups G and H then $G \to H$ is a homomorphism $\phi : G \to H$

3. Category of topological spaces, if we have two topological spaces X and Y then $X \to Y$ is a continuous function $f : X \to Y$

Definition 11.2. *A category $\mathcal{C}$ consists of the following data:*

1. *A collection of objects $Ob(\mathcal{C})$*
2. *A collection of morphisms $Mor(\mathcal{C})$*
3. *For each morphism f, there are objects $\mathrm{dom}(f)$ and $\mathrm{cod}(f)$ such that $dom(f) \to cod(f)$ is a morphism in $Mor(\mathcal{C})$*
4. *A composition operation $Mor(\mathcal{C}) \times Mor(\mathcal{C}) \to Mor(\mathcal{C})$*
5. *An identity morphism $1_A : A \to A$ for each object $A \in Ob(\mathcal{C})$*

Lemma 11.3. *The following are true:*

1. *If $a \xrightarrow{f} b$ then $f1_a = f$ and $1_b f = f$.*
2. *If $a \xrightarrow{f} b \xrightarrow{g} c \xrightarrow{h} d$ then $h(gf) = (hg)f$*

Example 11.4. *Posets: $\mathbb{P}$ is a poset with $\leq$ binary relation such that*

1. *$a \leq a$ for all $a \in \mathbb{P}$*
2. *$a \leq b$ and $b \leq a \implies a = b$*
3. *$a \leq b$ and $b \leq c \implies a \leq c$*

Given poset $\mathbb{P}$, make "poset category" with objects the elements of $\mathbb{P}$. There is only one morphism $a \to b$ if $a \leq b$ and no morphism if $a \not\leq b$.

Definition 11.5. *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. An object is an initial if for all object b there is a exactly one arrow $a \to b$.*

Definition 11.6. *An arrow $a \xrightarrow{f} b$ in $\mathcal{C}$ is an isomorphism iff there is another $b \xrightarrow{f} a$ such that $gf = 1_b$ and $fg = 1_a$.*

Lemma 11.7. *If a, b are initial objects in $\mathcal{C}$ they are uniquely isomorphic.*

Proof. Let $a \xrightarrow{f} b$ and $b \xrightarrow{g} a$ be unique arrows from a to b and b to a respectively. Then we have $a \xrightarrow{gf} a$ and $b \xrightarrow{fg}$ so $gf = 1_a$ and $fg = 1_b$. □

Definition 11.8. *Object b is terminal iff for all a there is a unique $a \to b$ iff b is initial in $\mathcal{C}^{op}$*

Lemma 11.9. *Two terminal objects are uniquely isomorphic.*

Definition 11.10. *Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be categories. A functor from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{D}$ is $\mathcal{C} \xrightarrow{F} \mathcal{D}$. Assign to each object a of $\mathcal{C}$ an object $F(a)$ of $\mathcal{D}$. For each arrow $a \xrightarrow{f} b$ there is an arrow $F(a) \xrightarrow{F(f)} F(b)$ with $f(1_a) = 1_{F(a)}$. Additionally, $F(gf) = F(g)F(f)$*

12 Lecture 12: Ring Theory (Feb 8)

Definition 12.1. *A ring is a set R with two binary operations $+$ and $\times$ such that*

1. *$(R, +)$ is an abelian group*
2. *$(R, \times)$ is associative*
3. *$a \times (b + c) = a \times b + a \times c$ and $(b + c) \times a = b \times a + c \times a$ for all $a, b, c \in R$*

Example 12.2. *The following are rings*

1. $\mathbb{Z}, 2\mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$
2. $M_2(\mathbb{Z})$
3. $\{f : \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ *continuous*$\}$
4. $\{f : \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ *differentiable*$\}$

Definition 12.3. *R is commutative iff $rs = sr$ for all $rs \in R$*

Definition 12.4. *R is unital iff there exists $1_R \in R$ such that $1_R r = r 1_R = r$ for all $r \in R$*

Definition 12.5. *Let R, S be rings. A ring homomorphism from R to S if $\phi : R \to S$ satisfy:*

1. *$\phi(r + s) = \phi(r) + \phi(s)$ for all $r, s \in R$*
2. *$\phi(rs) = \phi(r)\phi(s)$ for all $r, s \in R$*
3. *$\phi(1_R) = 1_S$*

Definition 12.6. *Let S be a subring of R if S is a ring and the inclusion map $i : S \to R$ is a ring homomorphism.*

Definition 12.7. *Let $\phi : R \to S$ be a ring homomorphism then*

1. *$\ker(\phi) = \{r \in R : \phi(r) = 0\}$ is a subring of R*
2. *$\phi(R) = \{s \in S : \exists r \in R, \phi(r) = s\}$ is a subring of S*

Remark 12.8. *In general, not the case that $\ker(\phi)$ is a subring of R.*

Definition 12.9. *Let R be a ring. An ideal of R is a subring I of R such that*

1. *$I \leq (R, +)$*
2. *For all $a \in R$ and $b \in I$, $ab \in I$.*

Definition 12.10. *Let I be an ideal of R then we define* $r + I = \{r + i : i \in I\}$

13 Lecture 13: Ideals and Quotient Rings (Feb 10)

Theorem 13.1. *First Isomorphism Theorem of Rings: Let R, S be rings and $\phi : R \to S$ be a homomorphism with $\ker(\phi)$ an ideal of R and $\mathrm{im}(\phi)$ a subring of S. Then we get isomorphism*

$$\tau : \frac{R}{\ker(\phi)} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathrm{im}(\phi) \text{ and } \tau : r + \ker(\phi) \mapsto \phi(r).$$

Theorem 13.2. *The following are true for any ideals I, J of R:*

1. *$I + J =$ smallest ideal containing I and J*
2. *$I \cap J =$ largest ideal contained in I and J*
3. *$IJ = \{\sum_{i=1}^{n} r_i s_i | n \in \mathbb{N}, r_i \in I, s_i \in J\} \subseteq I \cap J$*
4. *Ideals of R/I are in bijection with ideals of R that contain I*

Definition 13.3. *R is a zero ring if $R = \langle 0_R \rangle$*
Note: If $1_R = 0_R$ then $r \cdot 1 = r \cdot 0 = 0$ and R is a zero ring.

Definition 13.4. *R is an integral domain iff*

1. *$1_R \neq 0_R$ (R is not a zero ring)*
2. *For all $a, b \in R$*
$$ab = 0 \implies a = 0 \text{ or } b = 0.$$

Definition 13.5. *R is a field iff*

1. *$1_R \neq 0_R$*
2. *Every element of $R \setminus \{0_R\}$ has a multiplicative inverse*

Exercise 13.6. *If R is a field then R is an integral domain.*

Definition 13.7. *Let R be a ring. Then $u \in R$ is a unit iff u has a multiplicative inverse.*
We let
$$U(R) = \{u \in R : u \text{ is a unit}\}.$$
$U(R)$ is a group under multiplication.

Definition 13.8. *An ideal I of R is principal iff $I = aR$*

Lemma 13.9. *Let R be any ring then R is the largest ideal and $\{0_R\}$ is the smallest ideal.*

Remark 13.10. *We have $R/R = \{0_R\}$ and $R/\{0_R\} \simeq R$*

Theorem 13.11. *Let R be a field and let I be an ideal then $I = 0$ or $I = R$*

Proof. Assume $I \neq 0$, let $a \in I$ and $a \neq 0$. There exist $b \in R$ such that $ab = 1 \in I$. In any ring $1 \in I$ iff $I = R$.

□

Theorem 13.12. *If $R \neq 0$ are the only two ideals of R then R is a field.*

Proof. Let $a \in R, a \neq 0$ then $(a) \neq \emptyset$ as $a \in (a)$ so $(a) = R$ so $1 \in (a)$ and $1 = ab$ for some b. □

Definition 13.13. *An ideal I of R is maximal iff*

1. *$I \neq R$*
2. *For all ideals $J \supseteq I$, $J = I$ or $J = R$*

I is maximal in poset $\{J : J \text{ ideal}, J \neq R\}$ ordered by $\subseteq$

Lemma 13.14. *If I is an ideal of R,*

$$I \text{ maximal} \iff R/I \text{ is a field.}$$

Proof. $R \neq I \iff 1_{R/I} \neq 0_{R/I}$. By I maximal iff there are only two ideals of R/I which are 0 and R/I. □

Definition 13.15. *Ideal I is prime iff*

1. *$I \neq R$*
2. *For all $a, b \in R$, $ab \in I \implies a \in I$ or $b \in I$*

Lemma 13.16. *R/I is an integral domain iff I is a prime ideal.*

Definition 13.17. *$Spec(R) = \{I : I \text{ is a prime ideal of } R\}$*

Theorem 13.18. *Let R be a ring. I is an ideal of R, $I \neq R$. Then there is a maximal ideal J such that $I \subseteq J$.*

14 Lecture 14: Zorn's Lemma and Modules (Feb 13)

Lemma 14.1. *Zorn's Lemma: If $\mathbb{P}$ is a poset such that every chain in $\mathbb{P}$ has an upper bound, then for every element p of $\mathbb{P}$ there is a $q \geq p$ with q maximal.*

Example 14.2. *Claim: $\mathbb{Q}$ satisfies the hypothesis of Zorn's Lemma.*

Proof. Let $(I_a : a \in A)$ be a chain in $\mathbb{Q}$. That is, I_a is ideal with $I_a \neq R$ and for $a, b \in A, I_a \subseteq I_b$ or $I_b \subseteq I_a$. We need upper bound, let

$$J = \bigcup_{a \in A} I_a = \{r : \text{there is } a \in A, r \in I_a\}.$$

Verify J is an ideal and for $r, s \in J$ then $r \in I_a$ and $s \in I_b$. WLOG let $I_a \subseteq I_b$ so $r, s \in I_b$ so $r + s \in I_b \subseteq J$.
Verify $J \neq R$, easy as $1 \notin I_a$ all a so $1 \notin J$. □

14.1 Modules

Definition 14.3. *Let R be a ring. A R-module is an abelian group $(M, +)$ equipped with a function $R \times M \to M$ by $(r, m) \mapsto rm$ such that*

1. $0_R m = 0_M, 1m = m$ *for all* $m \in M$
2. $(r_1 + r_2) = r_1 m + r_2 m$ *and* $m(r_1 + r_2) = mr_1 + mr_2$
3. $r(sm) = (rs)m$ *for* $r, s \in R$ *and* $m \in M$

Definition 14.4. *If M is a R-module, we can form "linear combinations"*

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} r_i m_i \text{ for } r_i \in R \text{ and } m_i \in M.$$

Example 14.5. *Let $R = \mathbb{Z}$ and $(G, +)$ be an abelian group. Then G is a $\mathbb{Z}$-module.*

Definition 14.6. *If M is a R-module, a submodule of M is N such that $N \leq (M, +)$, $rn \in N$ for $r \in R$ and $n \in N$.*

Remark 14.7. *If R is a ring, we can view R as a R-module. The ideals of R are the submodules of R (viewed as a R-module).*

Definition 14.8. *Let M, N be R-modules. A R-module homomorphism is a function $\phi : M \to N$ such that*

1. *ϕ is a group homomorphism for $(M, +)$ to $(N, +)$*
2. $\phi(rm) = r\phi(m)$ *for* $r \in R$ *and* $m \in M$

Note: This is like linear transformation in linear algebra.

15 Lecture 15: Modules (Feb 16)

Definition 15.1. *Let M and N be R-modules then we say $\phi : M \to N$ is R-linear if*

$$\phi\left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} r_i m_i\right) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} r_i \phi(m_i) \text{ for } r_i \in R \text{ and } m_i \in M.$$

Definition 15.2. *Let $M \leq N$ (M is submodule of N), $N/M = \{n + M : n \in N\}$. We define*

1. $(n_1 + M) + (n_2 + M) = (n_1 + n_2) + M$
2. $r(n + M) = (rn) + M$

We can define the R-linear quotient map $\phi_M : N \to N/M$ by $\phi : n \mapsto n + M$ with $\ker(\phi_M) = M$.

Theorem 15.3. *First Isomorphism Theorem for Modules: Let $\phi : M_1 \to M_2$ linear, then*

$$\operatorname{im}(\phi) \simeq \frac{M_1}{\ker(\phi)}.$$

via $m + \ker(\phi) \mapsto \phi(m)$

Definition 15.4. *Given R-module M and set $X \subseteq M$, the least submodule containing X is*

$$\operatorname{Span}(X) = \left\{\sum_{i=1}^{n} r_i x_i | n \in \mathbb{N}, r_i \in R, x_i \in X\right\}.$$

We specifically define $\operatorname{Span}(\emptyset) = \{0_M\}$

Definition 15.5. *If R is a ring, $X \subseteq R$ we write $\langle X \rangle$ for the least ideal containing X*

$$\langle X \rangle = \left\{\sum_{i=1}^{n} r_i x_i | n \in \mathbb{N}, r_i \in R, x_i \in X\right\}.$$

Definition 15.6. *A ring R is a principal ideal ring iff all ideals of R are principal (a principal ideal is of form Ra for some $a \in R$).*

Definition 15.7. *R is a principal ideal domain iff R is integral domain and principal ideal ring.*

Definition 15.8. *A ring R is noetherian iff every ideal of R is finitely generated. (An ideal is finitely generated if $I = Ra_1 + \cdots + Ra_n$ for some $a_1, \ldots, a_n \in R$.)*

Theorem 15.9. *If I is an ideal of R the ideals R/I are in bijection with $\{J : J \text{ ideal of } R, J \supseteq I\}$.*
Also prime ideals of R/I correspond to prime ideals of R that contain I.

Example 15.10. *Common PID's*

1. $\mathbb{Z}$
2. $k[x]$ *for k a field*

Definition 15.11. *R is a Euclidean Domain iff*

1. *R is integral domain*
2. *There is a function $\phi : R \setminus \{0\} \to \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $a, b \in R$, for $b \neq 0$, there exist q, r such that $a = bq + r$ either $r = 0$ or $\phi(r) < \phi(b)$*

Example 15.12. *If $R = \mathbb{Z}$ then $\phi(n) = |n|$ is a Euclidean Domain.*

Example 15.13. *If $R = k[x]$ for k a field then $\phi(f) = \deg(f)$ is a Euclidean function.*

Theorem 15.14. *If R is a Euclidean Domain then R is a PID.*

Proof. Let R be euclidean domain and let I be the ideal of R. If $I = 0$ then we're done. If $I \neq 0$ consider $\{\phi(r) | r \in I, r \neq 0\} \subseteq \mathbb{N}$. Let n be the minimal element and let $a \in I \setminus \{0\}$ such that $\phi(a) = n$. As $a \in I, Ra \subseteq I$. Let $b \in I$, find q, r such that $b = aq + r$ either $r = 0$ or $\phi(r) < n$. We have $r = b - aq \in I$. So $r = 0$ and $b \in Ra$. □

Lemma 15.15. *Facts about Integral Domains: Let R be an integral domain.*

1. *If $a \neq 0$ and $ab = ac$ then $a(b - c) = 0$*
2. *$Ra = Rb$ iff a and b are associates*

Lemma 15.16. *Let R be any ring, the following are true about units*

1. *u unit iff u has a multiplicative inverse*
2. *Units of R form a group under multiplication*
3. *$a, b \in R$ are called associates iff there is an unit u such that $au = b$.*

Example 15.17. *$\mathbb{Z}[x]$ is not a PID. Consider the ideal $\langle 2, x \rangle = \{f : \text{constant term of } f \text{ is even}\}$.*

Theorem 15.18. *R Noetherian iff $R[x]$ is Noetherian.*

16 Lecture 16: Integral Domains

Definition 16.1. *Let $p \in R$*

1. *p is prime if and only if p is a nonzero non-unit and for all $r, s \in R$, $p|rs$ implies $p|r$ or $p|s$.*
2. *p is irreducible if and only if p is a nonzero non-unit and for all $r, s \in R$ and $p = rs$ then one of r or s is a unit.*

Lemma 16.2. *The following are true*

1. *As R is an ID, for any $a \in R$, a nonzero non-unit iff $(a) \notin \{0, R\}$*
2. *If p is prime, then (p) is a prime ideal*
3. *p prime implies p is irreducible.*
4. *If R PID then prime $=$ irreducible.*
5. *In any ID, (0) is a prime ideal.*

Definition 16.3. *R is a unique factorization domain (UFD) iff*

1. *R is an integral domain*
2. *Every non-zero nonunit in R is a product $u_1, ..., u_n$, $n > 0, u_i$ irreducible.*
3. *If $m, n > 0$ then $u_1...u_n = v_1...v_m$ and u_i, v_j irreducible, then $m = n$ and u_i are associates and permutations of v_j*

Recall 16.4. *An R-module M is finitely generated (fg) if there are $m_1, ..., m_n \in M$ such that $M = \mathrm{Span}(m_1, ..., m_n)$.*

Definition 16.5. *An R-module N is Noetherian iff every submodule of N is finitely generated.*
Equivalently, Ring R is Noetherian iff R is Noetherian as an R-module that is all ideals are finitely generated.

Example 16.6. *Non-Noetherian Rings:*

$$R = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} \mathbb{Z}[x_1, ..., x_n].$$

Consider the ideal

$$I = \langle x_1, x_2, ... \rangle = \{f \in R : f \text{ has no constant term}\} = \{f : f(0, ...) = 0\}.$$

Proof. If I is finitely generated there is $h_1, ..., h_n \in I$ such that

$$I = Rh_1 + \cdots + Rh_n = (h_1) + \cdots + (h_n).$$

Each h_i has finite x_j's in it so find N so large that x_N does not appear in any h_i.
As $x_N \in I$ there are $f_1, ..., f_n \in R$ such that $x_N = \sum_{i=1}^n f_i h_i$. Substitute

$$x_j = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } j < N \\ 1 & \text{if } j \geq N \end{cases}.$$

Then we conclude $1 = 0$ which is a contradiction. □

Theorem 16.7. *Let M be a R-module then the following are equivalent*

1. *M is Noetherian*
2. *For any increasing change of submodules $N_0 \subseteq N_1 \subseteq N_2 \subseteq \cdots$ of M, the chain is eventually constant.*
3. *For any nonempty set X of submodules of M, there is some $N \in X$ which is maximal under inclusion.*

Proof. (1) $\implies$ (2): Consider $N_\infty = \bigcup_{i=0}^\infty N_i = \{m : \exists i \in \mathbb{N}, m \in N_i\}$.
Verify that N_∞ is a submodule of M, as M is noetherian, N_∞ is finitely generated say $N_\infty = \text{Span}(X)$ with $X \subseteq N_\infty$ finite. Find i such that $X \subseteq N_i$ then $N_\infty = \text{Span}(X) \subseteq N_i \subseteq N_j \subseteq N_\infty$ for $j \geq i$.

(2) $\implies$ (1): AFSOC there is $N \leq M$ with N not finitely generated. Take $n_0 \in N$ and $n_0 \neq 0$. Choose $n_1 \in N \setminus Rn_0$ and generally

$$n_k \subseteq N \setminus \left(\sum_{i<k} Rn_i \right).$$

In the end, let $N_i = \sum_{j<i} Rn_j$ then $N_0 < N_1 < N_2 < \cdots$, a contradiction. □

17 Lecture 17: PID (Feb 19)

Lemma 17.1. *If R PID then*

1. *R is Noetherian*
2. *0 is a prime ideal and 0 is maximal iff R is a field*
3. *For $a \neq 0, (a)$ prime iff a prime iff (a) maximal iff a irreducible*

Theorem 17.2. *If R is a PID then R UFD*

Claim 17.3. *Every nonzero non-unit $a \in R$ is a finite product of irreducibles.*

Proof. If not, choose a that is not a finite product of irreducibles such that (a) is maximal under inclusion, a not finite product of irreducibles so a is not irreducible.
So $a = bc$ where b, c not units. So $(a) \subsetneq (b)$ and $(a) \subsetneq (c)$ so b, c are finite products of irreducibles as (a) is maximal under inclusion. Contradiction so a is a finite product of irreducibles. □

Claim 17.4. *If $u_1...u_n = v_1...v_n$ with u_i, v_j irreducible then $m = n$ and u_i, v_j are the same up to permutations and associates.*

Proof. u_1 divides $v_1...v_m$. As R PID, u_1 is prime so $u_1|v_j$ for some j. As v_j is irreducible, u_i either unit or an associate of v_j. As u_i irreducible, u_i not a unit. So u_1 and v_j are associates. Say $u_1 = x \cdot v_j$ for x unit. Then

$$xu_2...u_n = v_1...v_{j-1}v_{j+1}...v_m.$$

Finish by induction. □

Corollary 17.5. *If k field, $k[x]$ is a UFD.*

Lemma 17.6. *If R PID and $p \in R$ irreducible then $R/(p)$ is a field.*

Theorem 17.7. *(Hilbert's Basissatz Theorem) If R Noetherian ring then $R[x]$ is Noetherian ring.*

Proof. Let I be ideal of $R[x]$. For each n let

$$J_n = \left\{ r \in R : \exists c_0, ..., c_{n-1} \in R, rx^n + \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} c_i x^i \in I \right\}.$$

J_n is an ideal of R.
Claim: $J_n \subseteq J_{n+1}$
Let $r \in J_n$ say $rx^n + \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} c_i x^i \in I$, as I ideal, $x(rx^n + ...) \in I$ so $r \in J_{n+1}$.

As R is noetherian, there is N such that $J_n = J_N$ for all $n \geq N$.
For each $n \leq N$, as R noetherian, J_n is finitely generated ideal of R. For each $n \leq N$,

choose a finite set $F_n \subseteq I$ such that if $\deg(f) = n$ then $f \in F_n$ and $\{$leading coeff of f : $f \in F_n\}$ generates J_n.
Let $F = \bigcup_{n \leq N} F_n$ and claim that F generates I (as an ideal of $R[x]$). Show by induction on $\deg(h)$ that every $h \in I$ is an $R[x]$-linear combination of elements of F.
(Base Case) $h = 0$, $\deg(h) \leq N$ and $h = rx^n + \sum_{in} c_i x^i$ where $r \in J_n$. SO find $\lambda_1, ..., \lambda_t \in R$ and $g_1, ..., g_t \in F_n$ such that $r =$ leading coefficient of $\sum_{i=1}^{t} \lambda_i g_i$. Look at $h - \sum_{i=1}^{t} \lambda_i g_i \in I$ has lower degree.
(Induction Step) Let $h \in I$ with $\deg(h) = n > N$, $h = rx^n + \sum_{i<n} c_i x^i$ with $r \in J_n = J_N$. Find $g'_1, ..., g'_s \in F_N, \lambda_1, ..., \lambda_s \in R$ such that $r =$ leading coefficients of $\sum_{j=1}^{s} \lambda_j g'_j$ with leading term in rx^N. So now look at $h - \sum_{j=1}^{s} \lambda_j x^{n-N} g'_j$. This has degree $< n$, so done by induction. $\square$

18 Lecture 18: Unique Factorization Domains (Feb 23)

Theorem 18.1. *R UFD $\implies$ $R[x]$ UFD*

Definition 18.2. *Field of Fractions: Given any integral domain R, constructing its "field of fractions" as $X = \{(a,b) \in R \times R : b \neq 0\}$.*
Define binary relation $\sim$ on X by

$$(a_1, b_1) \sim (a_2, b_2) \iff a_1 b_2 = a_2 b_1.$$

Definition 18.3. *Define $\frac{a}{b}$ to be the $\sim$-equivalence class of (a,b).*
The fractions form a ring F with $1_F = \frac{1}{1}$ and $0_F = \frac{0}{1}$. Every element has an inverse, so F is a field.

Remark 18.4. *If R is integral domain and F is a field of fractions then $F[x]$ is a PID.*

Definition 18.5. *Let R be an integral domain and let $a_1, ..., a_n \in R, a_i \neq 0$. A greatest common divisor (gcd) for $a_1, ..., a_n$ is $a \in R$ such that*

1. *$a | a_i$ for $i = 1, ..., n$*
2. *If $b | a_i$ for $i = 1, ..., n$ then $b | a$*

Remark 18.6. *If $\gcd(a_1, ..., a_n)$ exists, it is unique up to associates.*

Lemma 18.7. *If R UFD, then gcd's exist.*

Lemma 18.8. *If R PID and $(a_1, ..., a_n) = Ra_1 + \cdots + Ra_n$ then*

$$(a_1, ..., a_n) = (d) \iff d = \gcd(a_1, ..., a_n).$$

Definition 18.9. *Let R, S be rings, $\phi : R \to S$ a ring homomorphism.*

1. *If I is an ideal of R, I^e (extension of I) = ideal generated by $\phi[I]$ in S.*
2. *If J ideal of S, J^c (contraction) of J is $\phi^{-1}[J] = \{r \in R : \phi(r) \in J\}$.*

Lemma 18.10. *If we define $\psi : R/J^c \to S/J$ by $\psi : r + J^c \mapsto \phi(r) + J$, ψ is well defined injective homomorphism.*

Lemma 18.11. *If J is a prime ideal of S, then J^c is a prime ideal of R.*

Proof. S/J is ID, so all subrings of S/J are ID's, so R/J^c is ID, so J^c is prime ideal. $\square$

Recall 18.12. *If R a ring, a subset $S \subseteq R$ is multiplicatively closed iff $1 \in S$ and for all $s, t \in S$, $st \in S$.*
Define a "ring of fractions" $S^{-1}R$.

Theorem 18.13. *Let $X = \{(a, b) : a \in R, b \in S\}$ then*

$$(a_1, b_1) \sim (a_2, b_2) \iff \exists s \in S, s(a_1 b_2 - a_2 b_1) = 0.$$

Theorem 18.14. *Let the set be $S^{-1}R$. Define the map $\phi : R \to S^{-1}R$ by $\phi : r \mapsto \frac{r}{1}$. Then ϕ is a ring homomorphism but it may not be injective.*

Theorem 18.15. *Universal Property: For all rings A and all homomorphism $\psi : R \to A$ such that $\phi(s)$ is a unit in A for all $s \in S$. There is unique $X : S^{-1}R \to A$ such that $\psi = X \circ \phi$.*

$$\begin{tikzcd} R \arrow[r, "\phi"] \arrow[dr, "\psi"'] & S^{-1}R \arrow[d, dashed, "X"] \\ & A \end{tikzcd}$$

Proof. $X\left(\frac{x}{s}\right) = \psi(r)\psi(s)^{-1}$ □

19 Lecture 19: (Feb 25)

Theorem 19.1. *R UFD $\implies$ $R[x]$ UFD*

Remark 19.2. *As R ID for nonzero, $f, g \in R[x]$, $\deg(fg) = \deg(f) + \deg(g)$*

Definition 19.3. *Let $f \in R[x]$ with $f = 0$, f is primitive iff there is no prime $p \in R$ such that $p|f$ in $R[x]$*

Remark 19.4. *Informally, the* gcd *of the coefficients of f is 1.*

Lemma 19.5. *(Gauss's Lemma) If $f, g \in R[x]$ both primitive then fg is primitive.*

Proof. Suppose not, and let p be prime in R such that $p|fg$. As p prime, $P = (p)$ is prime ideal so R/P is ID. Let $\phi : R \to R/P$ quotient map.
Define $\phi^* : R[x] \to R/P[x]$ by

$$\phi^*\left(\sum_{i=0}^{n} a_i x^i\right) = \sum_{i=0}^{n} \phi(a_i) x^i.$$

ϕ^* is homomorphism. So $\phi^*(fg) = \phi^*(\phi(f)\phi(g)) = \phi(f)\phi(g)$ but $\phi^*(fg) = 0$ as $p|fg$.
As R/P ID, $\frac{R}{P}[x]$ is ID so $\phi^*(f) = 0$ or $\phi^*(g) = 0$. So $p|f$ or $p|g$ so a contradiction. □

Lemma 19.6. *Let $f \in R[x]$, $f \neq 0$. Then there are $C \in R$, $g \in R[x]$, g primitive and $f = Cg$*

Proof. $C = \gcd(a_0, ..., a_n)$ if $f(x) = a_0 + a_1 x + \cdots + a_n x^n$. □

Lemma 19.7. *Let $h \in F[x]$, then there is a nonzero $a \in F$ such that $ah \in R[x]$ and ah primitive.*

Lemma 19.8. *Let $f \in R[x]$ be irreducible with $\deg f > 0$. Then f irreducible in $F[x]$*

Proof. To show existence of factorization: Let $f \in R[x]$ nonzero and nonunit. Write $f = cg$ where $c \in R$ and $g \in R[x]$ primitive. If C nonunit (in R), use R being UFD to write $c = r_1 ... r_n$ with r_i irreducible in R.
Note: r_i still irreducible in $R[x]$.
We have $g \in R[x] \implies g \in F[x]$. If $\deg(g) > 0$ then g is not a unit and using $F[x]$ is UFD to write

$$g = h_1 ... h_n \text{ where } h_i \in F[x], h_i \text{ irreducible in } F[x].$$

Find $a_i \neq 0$ in F such that $H_i = a_i h_i \in R[x]$ primitive.
Note: H_i irreducible in $F[x]$.
So we can write

$$\prod_{i=1}^{n} H_i = \left(\prod_{i=1}^{n} a_i\right)\left(\prod_{i=1}^{n} h_i\right) = \left(\prod_{i=1}^{n} a_i\right) g.$$

Let $\prod a_i = \frac{A}{B}$ for $A, B \in R$ and $A, B \neq 0$. Then $B(\prod H_i) = Ag$. Argue that A, B must be associates so ϕa_i unit of R and WLOG $\prod a_i = 1$. □